

AXIOM AI TECHNOLOGIES

Business Continuity & Disaster Recovery Tabletop Exercise

Exercise ID: AAX-BCP-TTX-001 | Version 1.0 | Simulated Portfolio Exercise

Document Control	Value
Document Owner	Business Continuity / Information Security Lead
Approver	Executive Management
Exercise Type	Scenario-based tabletop exercise
Classification	Internal / Portfolio Case Study
Exercise Duration	90 minutes
Scenario	Critical AWS RDS PostgreSQL database failure
Primary References	BIA, BCP/DR Strategy, Business Continuity Plan, Disaster Recovery Plan

1. Purpose

This tabletop exercise evaluates whether Axiom AI Technologies' business continuity and disaster recovery arrangements support timely decision-making, escalation, communication, service recovery, and restoration of critical business activities following a major production database failure. The exercise validates the practical usability of the BCP and DRP without performing destructive technical actions against a live environment.

2. Exercise Objectives

- Validate roles, responsibilities, escalation paths, and decision authority during a major technology disruption.
- Evaluate whether the documented BCP and DRP provide sufficient guidance for coordinated response and recovery.
- Test awareness of Recovery Time Objective (RTO), Recovery Point Objective (RPO), and Maximum Tolerable Period of Disruption (MTPD).
- Assess communication and stakeholder notification processes.
- Identify dependencies, documentation gaps, resource constraints, and recovery assumptions.
- Produce actionable findings that can be tracked through the corrective-action process.

3. Scope

The exercise covers a simulated failure of the production PostgreSQL database hosted on AWS RDS and the resulting impact on customer-facing SaaS functionality and internal business operations. It covers incident declaration, business impact assessment, escalation, communications, recovery decision-making, restoration, validation, and transition to normal operations.

Out of scope:

- Actual deletion, corruption, failover, or modification of production data.
- Live penetration testing, vulnerability scanning, malware execution, or exploitation.
- Real customer notification or external incident reporting.
- Changes to production infrastructure.

4. Participants and Roles

Role	Primary Responsibility	Expected Exercise Focus
Exercise Facilitator	Controls scenario and injects; records observations.	Prompt decisions and prevent solutioning from becoming a technical implementation.
Incident Lead	Coordinates technical response and recovery.	Establish incident severity, technical actions, dependencies, and recovery status.
Executive Approver / Escalation Lead	Provides business decisions and authorization.	Prioritize services, approve major recovery decisions, and manage risk acceptance.
Operations / Communications Lead	Coordinates internal and stakeholder communications.	Establish cadence, audience, messaging, and escalation.
Scribe / Evidence Owner	Records decisions, timestamps, actions, and findings.	Maintain decision log and evidence for post-exercise review.

5. Exercise Rules

- This is a discussion-based exercise; participants describe what they would do rather than perform live changes.
- Assume normal organizational roles, authorities, and communication channels unless the scenario states otherwise.
- Participants should use the BCP and DRP as primary references and identify where those documents are unclear or incomplete.
- The facilitator may introduce additional facts through timed injects.
- Participants are not expected to know an answer that is not documented; uncertainty is itself a useful finding.
- Record material decisions, assumptions, gaps, and action items.

6. Scenario Overview

At 09:00 UTC, monitoring indicates that the production PostgreSQL database hosted on AWS RDS is unavailable. Customer-facing application functions dependent on the database are failing or timing out. Initial checks suggest a database-level failure rather than a broader AWS regional outage. The technical team cannot immediately determine whether the issue is caused by infrastructure failure, storage corruption, configuration, or another database-level condition.

The incident has the potential to affect critical SaaS workflows and may approach established recovery thresholds if service is not restored. The exercise proceeds through escalating injects requiring technical, operational, and executive decisions.

7. Criticality and Recovery Targets

Measure	Exercise Reference	Meaning	Decision Relevance
MTPD	As established in the BIA	Maximum tolerable disruption before unacceptable business impact.	Triggers urgent escalation and continuity decisions.

RTO	As established in the BIA/BCP	Target time to restore the affected service.	Measures whether recovery remains achievable.
RPO	As established in the BIA/DRP	Maximum acceptable data loss measured in time.	Determines acceptable restore point and recovery method.

Participants must consult the approved BIA/BCP/DRP values rather than inventing new targets during the exercise. If the documents do not provide a sufficiently clear value, record that as a documentation gap.

8. Exercise Timeline and Injects

Time	Inject	Situation	Expected Discussion	Evidence
09:00	1 — Detection	Production RDS database becomes unavailable. Application errors increase.	How is the incident detected, classified, and declared? Who is notified?	Incident declaration, timestamp, initial severity.
09:10	2 — Initial Triage	Application remains unavailable. Root cause is unknown.	What immediate checks are performed? What assumptions must be avoided?	Initial assessment and technical action list.
09:20	3 — Business Impact	Customer workflows are failing and support tickets begin increasing.	Which BIA activities are affected? Has an RTO/MTPD threshold been reached or threatened?	Impact assessment and threshold decision.
09:30	4 — Escalation	Recovery is not immediately successful. Estimated restoration time is uncertain.	Who has authority to escalate? What decisions require executive approval?	Escalation record and decision log.
09:40	5 — Recovery Choice	A known-good recovery point is available, but the most recent data may not be included.	How is RPO evaluated? Who approves potential data loss? What recovery path is selected?	Recovery decision and rationale.
09:55	6 — Communications	Customer-facing disruption continues while recovery is underway.	What is communicated internally? What would trigger customer, vendor, or regulatory communications?	Communication plan and notification criteria.
10:10	7 — Restoration	Database service is restored. Validation is	What validation is required? Who authorizes return	Recovery checklist and validation evidence.

		required before normal operations resume.	to normal operations?	
10:20	8 — Transition	Service is stable but the incident is not yet closed.	What post-incident actions are required? What evidence and lessons should be captured?	Closure criteria and action list.

9. Decision and Escalation Thresholds

- Incident declaration: activate documented incident response and continuity processes when the disruption materially affects a critical service.
- Business continuity escalation: escalate when projected disruption threatens an established RTO or MTPD, or when recovery uncertainty prevents confidence in meeting the target.
- Executive decision: obtain management authorization when recovery requires material business risk acceptance, significant service degradation, or acceptance of data loss against the documented RPO.
- External communication consideration: assess contractual, legal, regulatory, customer, and vendor notification requirements based on the facts of the incident. Do not assume that service disruption alone establishes a reporting obligation.
- Recovery completion: do not close the incident solely because infrastructure is available; validate application functionality, data integrity, security controls, monitoring, and business process availability.

10. Facilitator Evaluation Criteria

Area	Expected Evidence	Rating	Observations
Incident recognition	Clear declaration, severity, owner, and timestamp.		
Business impact assessment	Critical activities and dependencies identified.		
Escalation	Thresholds and authority applied consistently.		
Communications	Appropriate audience, cadence, and message ownership.		
Recovery decision	Recovery option selected using RTO/RPO and risk information.		
Technical recovery	Documented recovery steps followed or gaps identified.		
Validation	Service/data/security validation completed before closure.		
Evidence and records	Decision log, action list, and exercise observations captured.		

11. Evidence to Capture

- Attendance and participant roles.
- Exercise timeline and inject responses.
- Incident / decision log.
- Recovery checklist or runbook references used.
- RTO, RPO, and MTPD decisions or assumptions.
- Communication and escalation decisions.
- Identified gaps, risks, and dependencies.
- Corrective actions with owner, priority, and target date.

12. Success Criteria

- Participants can identify the correct continuity and recovery procedures without relying solely on facilitator guidance.
- Roles and escalation authority are understood.
- Critical business impacts and dependencies are identified.
- RTO/RPO/MTPD are applied consistently using approved organizational targets.
- Recovery decisions are documented with clear rationale.
- Communications and notification criteria are identified.
- Recovery validation and incident closure requirements are understood.
- All significant gaps are converted into trackable improvement actions.

13. Exercise Outputs

The completed exercise should produce an attendance record, decision log, facilitator observation record, identified findings, and corrective-action list. Findings should be transferred to the Testing & Lessons Learned artifact in Section 06 of the project.

14. Post-Exercise Review

Immediately following the exercise, the facilitator should conduct a short hotwash with participants. The hotwash should capture what worked, what was unclear, what assumptions proved incorrect, and which recovery or communication steps require improvement. Formal findings and corrective actions should then be documented in the Testing & Lessons Learned record.

15. Document Control

Version	Date	Owner	Change
1.0	2026-10-03	Business Continuity / Information Security Lead	Initial portfolio exercise document.

Review Frequency: At least annually and after material changes to the BIA, BCP, DRP, architecture, critical dependencies, or major incidents/exercises.